

Welcome to yet another installment of Zero1 Awards, our roundup of the very best performing products of the calendar year. Every year, day in day out, the Digit Test Centre puts several hundreds of products through rigorous tests, and meticulously ranks and rates them in order of merit. Why? Because we all deserve the best products and picking the right one can be so darn difficult – today’s prince is tomorrow’s pauper as the pace of innovation and high-performing gadgets takes no prisoners. Whether its the latest mirrorless camera or a hotly-anticipated graphics card for an in-depth Bazaar review, the Digit Test Centre proceeds with the single-minded goal of giving our readers the best knowledge about the latest and greatest products. That’s always been our aim while reviewing and writing about any product that’s printed in Digit’s *Tried and Tested* section pages, and it will continue to remain our focus as long as there are products to review in the market.

We’ve dropped a few categories from last year, and introduced new ones including CPU Coolers, All-in-One Desktops and Smartphone Cameras. This year we tested close to 400 products in all our comparison tests, and a little shy of 300 products in our bazaar section pages. During what we call “Zero 1 season” we called for some of these products back for every category and threw in a lot of new, previously untested products to tell you which are the best performing products of 2013. And we’re left with close to a crore worth of products to play with! Don’t even think of visiting

our offices over the next month or two, our security system rivals Fort Knox!

With that in mind, let’s outline the significance of this story and the iconic trophy on the page alongside. The Zero1 Award is different from all our other awards that we hand out in our comparison tests, because it’s a shoot-out of all the Best Performers of the year, and their most recently launched challengers. The product categories are carefully picked to ensure we have reviewed enough products in any given category to speak authoritatively about it. We also summarise the highs and lows of a Zero1 Award product category in the introduction of their respective pages, trying to give our readers an idea of what transpired in that product category throughout the year, and predict future trends (if any). And although performance really is king in this Award’s category, we also list out some of the recommended buys for different usage scenarios, or budgets (wherever applicable), to ensure that with this one issue of Digit, you’re armed with enough knowledge to be able to buy the best product you possibly can in their respective categories.

After a rather hectic month of testing – not to mention blood, sweat, tears, and sleepless nights – the Digit Team is proud to announce the winners of the Zero1 Awards 2013. These are the best products that have entered our hallowed halls and will serve as benchmarks for future challengers. We hope you find the following pages useful, while the team now recuperates in the best possible way – diving into more gadgets for the coming year. Some things never change.

Jayesh Shinde

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